

Phonics Play: 7-Day Reading Routine

A gentle, printable 10-minute routine for helping young learners practice letter sounds, listening, and early word-building—one small step at a time.

FREE QUICK-START GUIDE

For grown-ups: This guide is for playful practice, not a promise of a certain reading level by a certain day. Keep it light, celebrate effort, and repeat favorite activities as needed.

Created by Ting Lott, RN & educator • ARTISY

ARTISY Phonics Play • Personal-use family learning guide

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Your 10-minute rhythm

Short and consistent beats long and stressful. Use this rhythm each day, then stop while it still feels good.

1 minute — Settle in

Pick a comfortable spot. Say: “We are here to play with sounds.”

3 minutes — Hear it

Say today’s sound. Stretch it. Let your child echo it.

3 minutes — Find it

Look for the letter on a page, package, sign, or letter card.

3 minutes — Build or draw

Make the letter, draw something that starts with it, or blend simple sounds.

Before you begin: Grab a pencil/crayon, any paper, and optional letter cards. Choose a time when your child is fed and reasonably rested. If frustration rises, take a movement break and return later.

A helpful phrase

“Let’s listen for the sound together.” Avoid turning practice into a test. If the answer does not come, model it warmly and move on.

ARTISY Phonics Play • Day-by-day routine

Days 1–2

Meet sounds through play

Day 1 — Sound hunt

Choose: M, S, T, A, or P.

Say the sound—not the letter name—three times. Hunt for one item around you that begins with that sound.

☐ We said the sound

☐ We found or drew an item

Our sound:

Day 2 — Make the letter

Use pencil, finger-in-the-air, play dough, or objects to make yesterday’s letter. Say its sound as you form it.

☐ We made the letter

☐ We said its sound

What felt fun?

Try this: For /m/, hum “mmmm” while pretending to taste something yummy. For /s/, stretch “ssss” like a friendly snake. Keep sound play silly and short.

ARTISY Phonics Play • Days 1–2

Days 3–4

Connect sound to print

Day 3 — Letter detective

Find today’s letter in a book, grocery flyer, label, or handwritten note. Make a small mark every time you spot it.

- ☐ We looked for the letter
- ☐ We found it at least once

Letter we found:

Day 4 — Picture + sound

Draw one picture that starts with today's sound. Say the word slowly and listen for the beginning.

- ☐ We drew or named a picture
- ☐ We stretched the first sound

Our picture:

If your learner already knows letters: choose two sounds and ask which sound comes first in a simple word, such as sun, map, tap, or sat. Say each word slowly; there is no need to rush.

ARTISY Phonics Play • Days 3–4

Days 5–6

Try simple sound blending

Day 5 — Tap and slide

Pick a simple three-sound word, such as **sat**, **map**, or **tap**. Tap once for each sound: /s/ /a/ /t/. Then slide the sounds together.

- ☐ We tapped sounds
- ☐ We tried sliding them together

Word we tried:

Day 6 — Switch one sound

Start with a word your learner practiced. Change just the first sound: **sat** → **mat** or **tap** → **map**. Listen to how the word changes.

- ☐ We changed one sound
- ☐ We listened for the new word

Words we played with:

Remember: It is okay if blending does not click today. Model the sounds, praise the trying, and circle back another day. Repetition is the practice.

ARTISY Phonics Play • Days 5–6

Day 7

Celebrate and choose what comes next

Replay a favorite activity. Let your learner choose: sound hunt, letter making, detective search, picture drawing, tap-and-slide, or sound switch.

Then ask: “Which sound do you want to play with next week?” Write it below.

7-day tracker

Day **We practiced** **What we enjoyed**

1 ☐

2 ☐

3 ☐

4 ☐

5 ☐

6 ☐

7 ☐

★ ★ ★

Showing up matters. Keep the tracker as a small record of your family’s practice—not a report card.

ARTISY Phonics Play • Day 7

Keep it going

Next-week idea bank

- Repeat a favorite sound with new objects to find.
- Make a mini “sound book” with one drawing per page.
- Practice two or three familiar letters before adding a new one.
- Read a short picture book and listen for one target sound.
- Put magnetic letters in a tray and build a few simple words together.

A gentle boundary: If your child is persistently struggling with speech, hearing, or early reading skills, consider sharing your observations with their teacher or qualified pediatric professional. This family activity is not an assessment or a replacement for individualized support.

Explore more family resources, calming music, wellness tools, and learning activities at **shop.artistrystore.com**.

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